Ras Tafari Inc.

Full Spectrum at Rainbow Beach · Chicago 501(c)(3) · EIN 42-3036705

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The Joyce Foundation, Culture Program

November 2026

Letter of inquiry: Creating the Scene at Rainbow Wednesdays · $50,000 over 12 months

Dear Culture Program team,

OUR REQUEST

Ras Tafari Inc. requests **$50,000 over 12 months** for **Creating the Scene**. Paid South Side visual artists and experienced DJs will work with young South Shore DJs, families and elders to make Rainbow Wednesdays, 14 free summer evenings at Rainbow Beach Park (June 2 to September 1, 2027). Together they will create the music, the setting and the stories behind both.

WHO WE ARE

Ras Tafari Inc. is a Chicago 501(c)(3) (IRS determination June 9, 2026) that brings free music and cultural programs to South Side families, and the producer of SelassieFest. Our first program, Full Spectrum at Rainbow Beach, centers on the Rainbow DJ Lab: a free, year-round DJ class every Tuesday in the Rainbow Beach Park fieldhouse from January 12, 2027, with 12 stations, two resident DJ instructors and a guest woman DJ every week. Our five-member board is in place, insurance has been in force since October 22, 2026, and our partnership proposal has been with the Chicago Park District since October 27, 2026.

THE NEED

South Shore has the lake, an open lawn and a neighborhood full of musicians and artists. Free, high-quality cultural programming still gathers downtown, though, and families should not have to travel to Grant Park to see it. Women also remain rare behind the decks: USC Annenberg found women were under 6% of producers on the 2024 Hot 100. Your Culture Program supports “the development, growth, and visibility of underrepresented artists.” Joyce's 2019 support for TRUE Skool, where Milwaukee youth made new work with three pioneering women hip-hop artists, is the kind of artist-led work we hope to bring to South Shore.

HOW IT WORKS

- **Signature pieces.** Two artist commissions, a DJ booth front and a welcome piece, give the series a look the neighborhood recognizes all season.
- **Every week.** A contributing artist leads a community design session with young DJs, families and elders on that night's color and theme. The artist then makes the night's artwork: banners, table art and displays on South Shore landmarks, sayings, family traditions and Chicago house music history.
- **On the night.** Young DJs perform beside experienced DJs and a woman DJ mentor, inside a setting they helped imagine, and the artists are introduced from the booth. Every piece is temporary, installed and removed the same night, subject to Park District approval. Accessible paths, clear sightlines and seating for elders stay open.
- **Paid and documented.** Every artist and DJ works under a written agreement and is paid. We report fees paid, sessions held, performances, consented photos and recordings, and short reflections from youth, artists and audiences. Our mark of success is 300 people a night.

BUDGET

Artist fees: two signature commissions (2 × $3,000)	$6,000
Artist fees: weekly theme artwork (14 × $500)	$7,000
Artist fees: community design sessions (14 × $300)	$4,200
Fabrication, materials, installation and removal	$6,200
Guest DJs and women DJ mentors (14 nights)	$8,400
Sound and production (14 nights)	$9,100
Documentation, accessibility and evaluation	$5,000
Artistic direction and administration	$4,100
Total request	**$50,000**

Artist fees are based on published Chicago compensation benchmarks and comparable South Side commissions, subject to final scope and artist quotes. The DJ Lab's year-round classes and equipment are funded separately; this request does not cover K-12 instruction.

We would welcome your guidance on fit and timing, and would be glad to send the full plan, artist roles and budget detail.

With respect,
Stephen Henry
President, Ras Tafari Inc.